

Container Security: From Basics to Advanced Protection

Complete Course Outline

Total Duration: 3 hours 30 minutes - 4 hours

Level: Intermediate

Prerequisites: Basic Docker/container knowledge, Linux command line familiarity

Module 0: Course Introduction

Duration: 15-20 minutes

Videos:

1. **Welcome and Course Overview** (8-10 mins)
 - Course structure and learning path
 - Target audience and prerequisites
 - Lab environment setup overview
 - What you'll build by the end
2. **Container Security Landscape** (7-10 mins)
 - Why container security matters
 - Common misconceptions about container isolation
 - Real-world breach examples
 - Security layers overview

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the scope and structure of the course
 - Recognize the importance of container security
 - Set up the lab environment successfully
 - Identify key security challenges in containerized environments
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Module 1: Container Security Fundamentals

Duration: 30-35 minutes

Videos:

1. **Container Isolation Deep Dive** (10-12 mins)
 - How containers actually work (namespaces, cgroups)
 - The shared kernel reality
 - Isolation vs. virtualization
 - **Demo:** Examining namespace isolation with live commands

2. **Privileged Containers: The Security Nightmare** (10-12 mins)

- What makes a container privileged
- Capabilities and their risks
- **Lab:** Creating and examining privileged containers
- **Demo:** Breaking out of a privileged container

3. **Container APIs and Attack Surface** (10-11 mins)

- Docker daemon socket exposure
- Remote API vulnerabilities
- **Demo:** Exploiting exposed Docker socket
- Securing container APIs

Learning Objectives:

- Explain how Linux namespaces and cgroups provide container isolation
- Identify the risks of privileged containers
- Recognize exposed container APIs as critical vulnerabilities
- Demonstrate a privileged container escape attack

Hands-On Labs:

- Lab 1.1: Exploring namespace isolation
- Lab 1.2: Privileged container exploitation
- Lab 1.3: Docker socket vulnerability demonstration

Module 2: Container Attack Vectors and Vulnerabilities

Duration: 35-40 minutes

Videos:

1. **Container Escape Techniques** (12-15 mins)

- Kernel exploits through containers
- Capability abuse scenarios
- **Demo:** CVE-based container escape (using safe examples)
- Detection and prevention strategies

2. **Image Security and Tampering** (12-13 mins)

- Malicious image analysis
- Supply chain attacks on images
- **Lab:** Analyzing a compromised image
- Image signing and verification with Docker Content Trust
- **Demo:** Setting up content trust

3. **Insecure Configurations and DoS Attacks** (11-12 mins)

- Common misconfigurations (volume mounts, network modes)
- Resource limit bypasses
- **Demo:** Fork bomb and resource exhaustion attacks
- Implementing resource constraints
- **Lab:** Configuring secure container limits

Learning Objectives:

- Identify and exploit common container escape vectors
- Analyze container images for security vulnerabilities
- Recognize insecure container configurations
- Implement resource controls to prevent DoS attacks
- Use Docker Content Trust for image verification

Hands-On Labs:

- Lab 2.1: Container escape simulation
- Lab 2.2: Compromised image forensics
- Lab 2.3: Resource limit configuration and testing

Module 3: Seccomp Profiles in Practice (Sample Module)

Duration: 40-45 minutes

Videos:

1. **Introduction to Seccomp** (12-14 mins)
 - What is Seccomp and why it matters
 - System call filtering fundamentals
 - Default Docker Seccomp profile analysis
 - **Demo:** Viewing active Seccomp profiles
 - **Lab:** Testing default profile restrictions
2. **Creating Custom Seccomp Profiles** (14-16 mins)
 - Seccomp profile syntax and structure
 - Identifying required syscalls for applications
 - **Live Coding:** Building a profile from scratch
 - **Demo:** Using strace to discover syscall requirements
 - Testing and validating profiles
 - **Lab:** Create profiles for nginx and Python apps
3. **Advanced Seccomp: Troubleshooting and Best Practices** (14-15 mins)
 - Debugging Seccomp denials
 - **Demo:** Reading audit logs and kernel messages
 - Balancing security and functionality
 - Profile maintenance strategies
 - **Lab:** Troubleshooting a broken application
 - Real-world profile examples
 - Integration with orchestration platforms

Learning Objectives:

- Explain how Seccomp filters system calls at the kernel level
- Analyze and interpret the default Docker Seccomp profile
- Use strace and audit tools to identify application syscall requirements
- Create custom Seccomp profiles for specific applications

- Debug and troubleshoot Seccomp-related application failures
- Apply Seccomp profiles in production environments

Hands-On Labs:

- Lab 3.1: Exploring default Seccomp behavior
 - Lab 3.2: Building custom profiles with strace
 - Lab 3.3: Multi-container application profiling
 - Lab 3.4: Troubleshooting and fixing profile issues
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Module 4: Mandatory Access Control - AppArmor and SELinux

Duration: 30-35 minutes

Videos:

1. **AppArmor Fundamentals** (14-16 mins)
 - MAC vs. DAC security models
 - AppArmor architecture and modes
 - Default Docker AppArmor profile
 - **Demo:** Examining AppArmor enforcement
 - **Live Coding:** Creating custom AppArmor profiles
 - **Lab:** Profile generation and refinement
2. **SELinux for Container Security** (16-19 mins)
 - SELinux context and labels
 - Container-specific SELinux policies
 - **Demo:** SELinux in enforcing mode with containers
 - Multi-category security (MCS) for isolation
 - **Lab:** Configuring SELinux contexts
 - **Demo:** Troubleshooting SELinux denials
 - Choosing between AppArmor and SELinux

Learning Objectives:

- Differentiate between DAC and MAC security models
- Configure and enforce AppArmor profiles for containers
- Understand SELinux contexts and their role in container isolation
- Generate and customize MAC profiles for applications
- Troubleshoot AppArmor and SELinux policy violations
- Select the appropriate MAC system for your environment

Hands-On Labs:

- Lab 4.1: AppArmor profile creation workflow
 - Lab 4.2: SELinux context management
 - Lab 4.3: Comparative analysis - AppArmor vs SELinux
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Module 5: Orchestration and Supply Chain Security

Duration: 30-35 minutes

Videos:

1. **Kubernetes Security Fundamentals** (14-16 mins)
 - Pod Security Standards (Restricted, Baseline, Privileged)
 - Security contexts and policies
 - **Demo:** Implementing Pod Security Admission
 - Network policies for container isolation
 - **Lab:** Creating restrictive security contexts
 - **Demo:** Network policy enforcement
2. **Supply Chain Security and Best Practices** (16-19 mins)
 - Image scanning and vulnerability management
 - **Demo:** Trivy and Gype in action
 - Software Bill of Materials (SBOM)
 - Signed artifacts with Sigstore/Cosign
 - **Lab:** Setting up automated image scanning
 - **Demo:** Image signing workflow
 - Runtime security monitoring
 - **Demo:** Falco for runtime threat detection

Learning Objectives:

- Implement Pod Security Standards in Kubernetes
- Configure security contexts for least privilege access
- Use network policies to enforce container isolation
- Integrate image scanning into CI/CD pipelines
- Sign and verify container images
- Deploy runtime security monitoring tools
- Develop a comprehensive container security strategy

Hands-On Labs:

- Lab 5.1: Pod Security Standards implementation
- Lab 5.2: Image scanning pipeline setup
- Lab 5.3: Runtime monitoring with Falco

Module 6: Conclusion and Real-World Application

Duration: 10-15 minutes

Videos:

1. **Security Layering Strategy** (5-7 mins)
 - Defense in depth for containers
 - Combining Seccomp, AppArmor/SELinux, and policies
 - Risk assessment framework
 - **Visual:** Security maturity model

2. Next Steps and Resources (5-8 mins)

- Implementing security in existing environments
- Staying current with container security
- Community resources and tools
- Common pitfalls to avoid
- Final Q&A topics

Learning Objectives:

- Design a layered container security architecture
 - Prioritize security controls based on risk assessment
 - Create an implementation roadmap for your organization
 - Access ongoing learning resources
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Course Delivery Notes

Content Mix (per publisher requirements):

- **PowerPoint/Slides:** 20-25% (concepts, architecture diagrams, security models)
- **Terminal/CLI:** 35-40% (live demos, command execution, log analysis)
- **Code Editor:** 20-25% (profile creation, YAML files, configuration)
- **Browser:** 15-20% (documentation, dashboards, scanning tools)

Technical Standards:

- Resolution: 1920x1080 (Full HD)
- Frame Rate: 30 FPS constant
- Screen Zoom: 150% for all applications
- Code Editor: Font size adjusted to show 20-22 lines maximum
- Terminal: Large font with high contrast theme
- All windows maximized

Pedagogical Approach:

- **No lecture-only content** - every concept paired with demonstration
- **Progressive complexity** - each module builds on previous knowledge
- **Immediate practice** - hands-on labs follow theory within same video
- **Real-world scenarios** - all examples based on actual vulnerabilities
- **Troubleshooting focus** - teach debugging alongside implementation

Assessment Strategy:

- **Module-level quizzes:** 3 MCQs per module (18 total)
 - **Hands-on labs:** 12 practical exercises with validation scripts
 - **Final assessment:** 10 comprehensive MCQs + 1 capstone lab
 - **Passing criteria:** 75% on assessments + all labs completed
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Equipment and Software Requirements

Instructor Setup:

- Linux environment (Ubuntu 20.04+ or similar)
- Docker Engine 24.0+
- Kubernetes cluster (minikube/kind acceptable)
- Code editor (VS Code recommended)
- Screen recording: OBS Studio or similar (1920x1080, 30fps)

Student Lab Environment:

- 4GB RAM minimum, 8GB recommended
- 20GB free disk space
- Linux VM or WSL2 on Windows
- Docker Engine and Docker Compose
- kubectl CLI
- Basic tools: strace, auditd, jq, curl

Pre-configured Lab Resources:

- Vulnerable container images (intentionally insecure)
- Sample Seccomp, AppArmor, and SELinux profiles
- Kubernetes manifests for all demos
- Validation scripts for lab exercises
- Reference documentation bundle

Version History

- **v1.0** - Initial Phase 1 outline
- **Target:** 3.5-4 hour complete course
- **Focus:** Practical, hands-on container security with emphasis on Seccomp, AppArmor, and SELinux